

## Facebook wants employees to replace iPhones with Android devices!

Facebook has reportedly asked its employees to switch from using iPhones to Android phones as it wants to improve its own 'horri-bad' Android app. According to a *Business Insider* report, banning iPhone is an effort to keep Facebook's Android app updated. The report says, "The Facebook management realises its Android app is sub-par – and believes that the only way employees will take fixing it seriously is if they have to deal with its issues day in and day out. It's a practice called 'dogfooding', from the phrase 'eating your own dog food'."

The report is attributed to some ex-Facebookers and others familiar with the development. However, Facebook is tight-lipped about the matter.



## NASA's nano-satellite is powered by Android phones

NASA has disclosed details about a project called PhoneSat, as part of which it built nano-satellites by using off-the-shelf consumer smartphones. The project was started at NASA's Ames Research Center at Moffett Field, California. Developed at a cost of \$3500 each, the three prototype satellites have been built in the shape of a cube that measures approximately 10 cm (4 inch).

PhoneSat 1.0 is NASA's first prototype smartphone satellite. It uses the Nexus One phone from HTC, which runs on the Android OS. The smartphone acts as the computing unit, and its camera is used for observing the earth while the sensors orient the satellite. The NASA website reports that, "NASA engineers kept the total cost of the components to build each of the three prototype satellites in the PhoneSat project to \$3,500, by using only commercial off-the-shelf hardware and keeping the design and mission objectives to a minimum, for the first flight."

The post added: "NASA PhoneSat engineers also are changing the way missions are designed by rapidly prototyping and incorporating existing commercial technologies and hardware. This approach allows engineers to see what capabilities commercial technologies can provide, rather than trying to custom-design technology solutions to meet set requirements. Engineers can rapidly upgrade the entire satellite's capabilities and add new features for each future generation of PhoneSats."



## Linux 4.0 to arrive by 2016?



The numbers in the Linux version 2.6 series had stretched on to version 2.6.39. Then came Linux 3.0. Now for those wondering if the 3 series will also keep churning out huge complex numbers, here is some good news.

According to a blog posting by Sean Michael Kerner, Linus Torvalds has declared his intention to jump the version number of the Linux kernel up to 4.0 when the second version number of the current branch gets close to reaching 'the 30s'. At the current kernel development speed, Linux 3.29 is expected to be released in the autumn of 2016.

Torvalds had shared his decision in a Q&A session at the Linux Foundation's 2012 North American LinuxCon conference at San Diego. The developer said that larger version numbers are harder to keep track of, and that he prefers to jump to the higher major version when the numbers get too unwieldy for his taste. This is what kernel developers did when they jumped to Linux 3.0 in July, last year. The current version of the kernel in development is Linux 3.6, which is expected to be released in the second half of September, *H Online* reported.